

# Oakwood Primary School

## Parent Handbook 2024-25

**Oakwood Lane, Millbrook, MB12 4ST**

**Tel:** 01234 567890

**Email:** [office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk](mailto:office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk)

**Website:** [www.oakwood-primary.sch.uk](http://www.oakwood-primary.sch.uk)

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## Welcome from the Headteacher

Dear Parents and Carers,

Welcome to Oakwood Educational Academy! Whether your child is just starting with us or continuing their journey through primary school, we are delighted to have you as part of our community.

This handbook contains essential information about our school policies, procedures, and day-to-day operations. Please keep it somewhere handy and refer to it throughout the year. If you have any questions that aren't answered here, our office team is always happy to help.

We look forward to working in partnership with you to ensure your child has a happy, successful year at Oakwood.

Warm regards,

**Mrs. Sarah Mitchell**

Headteacher

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## School Day Timings

**Morning:** - Gates open: 8:40am - Registration: 8:50am - School starts: 9:00am (children arriving after this time are marked late)

**Break Times:** - Morning break: 10:30am - 10:45am - Lunch: - Reception/KS1: 12:00pm - 1:00pm - KS2: 12:30pm - 1:30pm

**Afternoon:** - End of school day: 3:15pm - After-school club collections: 4:30pm or 5:30pm (depending on booking)

**Please ensure your child arrives on time.** Persistent lateness disrupts learning for the whole class and is recorded on your child's attendance record.

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## Attendance and Absence

### Reporting Absence

If your child is unable to attend school, you must notify us before 9:00am on each day of absence.

**Methods to report absence:** - Telephone: 01234 567890 (press 1 for absence line) - Email: [attendance@oakwood-primary.sch.uk](mailto:attendance@oakwood-primary.sch.uk)

Please provide: - Your child's full name and class - Reason for absence - Expected return date

### Authorised vs Unauthorised Absence

**Authorised absences** include: - Illness - Medical/dental appointments (please try to book outside school hours where possible) - Religious observance - Exceptional family circumstances (approved in advance)

**Unauthorised absences** include: - Holidays during term time - Shopping trips or family days out - Looking after siblings or other family members - Birthdays

### Holiday Requests

The Department for Education has made it clear that headteachers may not grant any leave of absence during term time unless there are exceptional circumstances.

We strongly discourage term-time holidays. Fines may be issued by the Local Authority for unauthorised absence.

If you feel you have exceptional circumstances, please complete a Leave of Absence request form (available from the school office) at least 4 weeks in advance.

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# School Uniform

All children are expected to wear school uniform every day. This helps create a sense of belonging and pride in our school.

## Standard Uniform

- **Jumper/Cardigan:** Navy blue with Oakwood logo
- **Shirt:** White polo shirt (with or without logo)
- **Trousers/Skirt/Pinafore:** Grey
- **Shoes:** Black school shoes (not trainers, except on PE days)
- **Coat:** Sensible coat appropriate for the weather

## Summer Term Options (after Easter)

- Blue checked dress
- Grey shorts
- Sandals (must have closed toes and heel strap)

## PE Kit

- White t-shirt
- Navy blue shorts
- Trainers (for outdoor PE)
- Plimsolls (for indoor PE)

**Children should come to school in their PE kit on their designated PE days** - they will not need to change at school.

## Additional Notes

- **Jewellery:** Stud earrings only. Watches are allowed. All jewellery must be removed for PE.
- **Hair:** Long hair should be tied back. Extreme hairstyles or unnatural hair colours are not permitted.
- **Nail varnish:** Not permitted.

**Lost Property:** Please label all items of clothing and belongings. Unnamed lost property is kept for one term then donated to charity.

Uniform with the school logo can be purchased from **Schoolwear Solutions** in Exeter or online at [www.schoolwearsolutions.co.uk](http://www.schoolwearsolutions.co.uk)

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## Physical Education

PE is an important part of the curriculum. All children must participate unless they have a written note from a parent/carer or doctor.

### PE Kit

All children should come to school in PE kit on their designated PE days. PE kit consists of: -  
White t-shirt - Navy shorts - Trainers

**During winter months** (November-February), children should also bring: - Tracksuit bottoms or leggings - A warm top (navy or black hoodie/sweatshirt)

### PE Days by Year Group

- **Reception:** Wednesday afternoons
- **Year 1:** Monday and Thursday
- **Year 2:** Tuesday and Friday
- **Year 3:** Monday and Wednesday
- **Year 4:** Tuesday and Thursday
- **Year 5:** Wednesday and Friday
- **Year 6:** Monday and Friday

Please ensure your child has appropriate footwear and outdoor clothing for outdoor PE sessions during colder months.

**Jewellery must be removed for PE** for safety reasons. If your child has recently had their ears pierced and cannot remove earrings, they must sit out of PE until the earrings can be removed. Please plan ear piercing for the start of the summer holidays to allow healing time.

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# Illness and Medical Matters

## When to Keep Your Child at Home

Please do not send your child to school if they: - Have a temperature of 38°C or above - Have been sick or had diarrhoea in the last 48 hours - Have an infectious disease (see list below) - Are unwell enough that they cannot participate in normal school activities

## 48-Hour Rule

**If your child has been sick or had diarrhoea, they must stay at home for 48 hours after the last episode.** This helps prevent the spread of infection to other children and staff.

## Infectious Diseases

Some illnesses require exclusion from school for specific periods:

| Illness                       | Exclusion Period                                                             |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chickenpox                    | Until all blisters have crusted over (usually 5 days)                        |
| Impetigo                      | Until lesions are crusted and healed, or 48 hours after starting antibiotics |
| Scarlet Fever                 | 24 hours after starting antibiotics                                          |
| Slapped Cheek (Fifth Disease) | None (once rash appears, no longer infectious)                               |
| Hand, Foot and Mouth          | Until feeling better and temperature has resolved                            |
| Conjunctivitis                | None, but see GP if severe                                                   |

**Head Lice:** Children with head lice do not need to be excluded from school. Please treat at home and notify the school office so we can alert other parents (anonymously).

## Medication at School

We can only administer prescribed medication that needs to be taken during the school day. You must complete a **Medication Consent Form** (available from the office) before any medication can be given.

All medication must: - Be in its original container with the prescription label - Be handed to the office staff (not sent in book bags) - Include clear dosage instructions

**We cannot administer paracetamol or other non-prescribed medication** unless there is a specific care plan in place (e.g., for chronic conditions).

## Asthma Inhalers

Children with asthma should have an inhaler in school at all times. Please ensure: - The inhaler is clearly labelled with your child's name - The expiry date is checked regularly - A spare inhaler is available if needed - The school office has a copy of your child's asthma care plan

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## School Meals and Break Time Snacks

### Hot School Meals

Hot meals are provided daily and must be ordered via **ParentPay** by **Wednesday each week** for the following week.

The cost is **£2.50 per meal** (KS2 only - Reception, Year 1 and Year 2 receive free school meals under the Universal Infant Free School Meals scheme).

A menu is sent home at the start of each half-term and is available on our website.

### Free School Meals (Income-Based)

If you receive certain benefits, your child may be eligible for free school meals regardless of year group. This eligibility also brings additional funding to the school (Pupil Premium), so please apply even if your child is in Reception, Year 1, or Year 2.

To check eligibility and apply, visit: [www.devon.gov.uk/freeschoolmeals](http://www.devon.gov.uk/freeschoolmeals)

### Packed Lunches

If your child brings a packed lunch, please ensure it is healthy and balanced.

**Please do not include:** - Nuts or products containing nuts (we have children with severe allergies) - Glass bottles - Fizzy drinks or energy drinks - Excessive sweets or chocolate bars

## Break Time Snacks

**Morning break** (KS2 only - KS1 and Reception receive free fruit): - Children may bring a healthy snack - Suitable snacks: fruit, vegetables, breadsticks, cheese - Not permitted: crisps, chocolate bars, sweets

**Water bottles:** Children should bring a named water bottle to school each day. These can be refilled throughout the day. Water is the only drink permitted in classrooms.

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## Safeguarding

**The safety and wellbeing of every child is our top priority.**

All staff at Oakwood are trained in safeguarding and child protection. If you have any concerns about a child's safety or welfare, please speak to:

**Mrs. Jane Henderson** - Deputy Head and Designated Safeguarding Lead

**Mrs. Sarah Mitchell** - Headteacher (Deputy DSL)

You can contact them via the school office or email: [safeguarding@oakwood-primary.sch.uk](mailto:safeguarding@oakwood-primary.sch.uk)

If you believe a child is in immediate danger, contact the Police on 999 or Devon Children's Services on 0345 155 1071.

**Early Help:** If you need support with parenting, family difficulties, or accessing services, please ask about our Early Help provision. We work with families to provide support before problems escalate.

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## Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND)

We are committed to ensuring that all children, including those with special educational needs or disabilities, receive the support they need to thrive.

**Mr. David Chen** is our Special Educational Needs Coordinator (SENCO) and is available to discuss any concerns you may have about your child's learning or development.

If you think your child may need additional support, please contact Mr. Chen via the school office or email: [sendco@oakwood-primary.sch.uk](mailto:sendco@oakwood-primary.sch.uk)

More information about our SEND provision can be found in our **SEN Information Report** on the school website.

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# School Staff 2024-25

## Leadership Team

- **Mrs. Sarah Thompson** - Headteacher
- **Mr. James Chen** - Deputy Head & Designated Safeguarding Lead
- **Ms. Rachel Green** - SENDCo

## Teaching Staff by Year Group

- **Reception:** Miss Emma Wilson
- **Year 1:** Mrs. Priya Patel
- **Year 2:** Mr. Tom Bradley
- **Year 3:** Ms. Lisa Morgan
- **Year 4:** Mr. David Kumar
- **Year 5:** Mrs. Jennifer Clarke
- **Year 6:** Mr. Andrew Foster

## Support Staff

- **School Office:** Mrs. Patricia Davies (Office Manager), Miss Kelly Brooks
- **Teaching Assistants:** 8 Teaching Assistants across year groups
- **Caretaker:** Mr. Alan Johnson
- **Midday Supervisors:** Mrs. Collins, Mrs. Ahmed, Mr. Patel
- **Cleaning Staff:** External contractor

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# Communication and Contact

## School Office Hours

The school office is open: - Monday to Friday: 8:30am - 4:00pm during term time



## How to Contact Us

- **General enquiries:** office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk or 01234 567890
- **Absence reporting:** attendance@oakwood-primary.sch.uk or 01234 567890 (press 1)
- **Safeguarding concerns:** safeguarding@oakwood-primary.sch.uk
- **SENCO:** sendco@oakwood-primary.sch.uk

## ParentPay

We use ParentPay for all payments including school meals, trips, clubs, and uniform items. You will receive login details when your child starts school. If you have any issues accessing ParentPay, please contact the office.

## School Website and Social Media

Our website (www.oakwood-primary.sch.uk) contains: - Term dates and holiday dates - Latest newsletters - School policies - Curriculum information - Contact details

We also post regular updates on Twitter: @OakwoodPrimary

## Newsletters

We send a newsletter home (via email and paper copy) at the end of each month. This contains important dates, reminders, and celebration of children's achievements.

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## Term Dates 2024-25

### Autumn Term 2024

- **First day:** Wednesday 4th September 2024
- **Half-term:** Monday 28th October - Friday 1st November 2024
- **Last day:** Friday 20th December 2024 (1:30pm finish)

### Spring Term 2025

- **First day:** Monday 6th January 2025
- **Half-term:** Monday 17th February - Friday 21st February 2025
- **Last day:** Friday 4th April 2025

## Summer Term 2025

- **First day:** Tuesday 22nd April 2025
- **May Day (school closed):** Monday 5th May 2025
- **Half-term:** Monday 26th May - Friday 30th May 2025
- **Last day:** Wednesday 23rd July 2025

## INSET Days (school closed to pupils)

- Monday 2nd September 2024
  - Tuesday 3rd September 2024
  - Monday 25th November 2024
  - Friday 14th February 2025
  - Thursday 24th July 2025
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## Thank You

Thank you for taking the time to read this handbook. We hope it answers most of your questions, but please don't hesitate to contact us if you need any further information.

We look forward to a wonderful year ahead!

**Oakwood Educational Academy**

*"Growing Together, Learning Forever"*